

Preregistration Template

The Hackles Kit

Hackles · a free kit · quillsup.org · October 2026

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File this before you look at any outcome data, on a public or institutional registry (for example OSF Registries or AsPredicted [VERIFY that the registry you choose is available and accepts education studies]). The template follows common preregistration headings and the Hackles analysis plan. Text in brackets is for you. The example answers show the style for Design B (delayed-start comparison of class tallies); change them for your design. Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled trial; say so in Section 1.

No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

01 Study information

FIELD	YOUR ENTRY	EXAMPLE
Title	[]	Change in Tell-Readiness in grade 6-8 classes taught Hackles lessons first versus delayed
Authors and affiliations	[]	[Names]. State any connection to the Hackles team
Date of registration and IRB protocol number	[]	[Date], [IRB #]
Status of the kit	[]	Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled trial and has not been approved by any agency. This study cannot show that it prevents harm
Description	[]	We compare class-level change in the share of students giving the best answer on the core items of the grades 6-8 survey between classes that receive ten Hackles lessons first and classes that receive them after the post survey

02 Hypotheses

STATE HYPOTHESES SO THAT a result could disagree with them.

#	HYPOTHESIS	DIRECTION
H1 (primary)	Class-level change in Tell-Readiness (percentage points, post minus pre) is larger in taught-first classes than in delayed classes	Two-sided test; we expect taught-first to be larger
H2 (secondary)	Item-level percent with the best answer rises more in taught-first classes on the three core items	Two-sided
H3 (secondary)	In taught-first classes, more matched students go up than down on the core score	Two-sided sign test, descriptive because classes cluster
Exploratory	Whether change differs by class size; whether the post survey is higher in classes taught by teachers with higher fidelity scores	Not tested for significance; hypothesis-generating only

03 Design plan

FIELD	ENTRY	EXAMPLE
Study type	[]	Quasi-experimental pre/post with a delayed-start comparison; classes assigned by [coin flip / schedule]
Blinding	[]	Analyst blind to class condition until the primary analysis is run; teachers cannot be blinded
Study design	[]	Two arms of [4] classes; pre in Week 0; post in Week 11; delayed classes receive lessons after the post survey
Randomization	[]	[Describe, or say it was not randomized and why]

04 Sampling plan

FIELD	ENTRY	EXAMPLE
Existing data	[]	Registration is prior to any data collection
Explanation of existing data	[]	No data exist yet
Data collection procedures	[]	Teachers give the Assessment Pack grades 6-8 survey on paper as ordinary classroom practice, with teacher-held codes, and send class tally sheets (counts only) to the independent custodian
Sample size	[]	8 classes (4 per arm), about 20 matched students each
Sample size rationale	[]	Assumptions: ICC 0.05; class size 20; $d = 0.8$. With 4 classes per arm, simulated power was about 0.73 for $d = 0.8$ and 0.35 for $d = 0.5$. We accept that the study can detect only large effects
Stopping rule	[]	We stop data collection after the Week 11 post survey. We do not add classes after seeing results

05 Variables

TYPE	VARIABLE	DEFINITION
Manipulated	Condition	taught_first or delayed
Primary outcome	Tell-Readiness	Percent of core item responses (grades 6-8 items 2, 5, 7) with the best answer: item 2 per the Assessment Pack key; item 5 rated 3 or 4; item 7 scored 2
Secondary outcomes	Item-level best-answer percentages for items 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9; matched-pair counts up/same/down on the core score	Per the codebook
Covariates (class level)	Class size; pre-survey Tell-Readiness	Used in sensitivity analyses only
Not collected	Student names, codes, demographics, free text	Privacy by design

06 Analysis plan

STATE THE EXACT TESTS before you see the data.

ITEM	ENTRY	EXAMPLE
Primary analysis	[]	For each class, compute Tell-Readiness pre and post and the change. Compare the mean change in taught-first versus delayed classes. Inference by exact randomization over all relabelings of classes (70 for 4 versus 4), with a Welch t-test and a class-resampling bootstrap interval reported as supporting results
Significance criterion	[]	Alpha = .05, two-sided, for H1 only
Secondary analyses	[]	Same procedure for each core item; report effect and interval, no adjustment, flagged as secondary
Multiple comparisons	[]	H1 is primary. Item-level results are secondary and exploratory; we will not describe any as confirmed
Missing data	[]	Items skipped are left out of that item's denominator (Assessment Pack rule). Students lost at post are in the pre tally only; we report n pre and n post for every class
Matching failures	[]	Students whose codes fail to match are counted in class tallies but not in matched pairs
Outliers and exclusions	[]	No exclusions of classes. A class with fewer than 10 matched students is reported but flagged as unstable
Suppression	[]	No subgroup with fewer than 10 students is reported
Sensitivity analyses	[]	Weight classes by size; drop one class at a time; analyze percent best-answer change on each core item
Deviations	[]	Any deviation will be listed with its reason in the final report

07 Outcomes we will not claim

- We will not claim that Hackles prevents harm, changes real-world behavior, or is effective or approved.
- We will not describe a significant result as proof, and will describe a non-significant result as inconclusive, not as evidence of no effect.
- We will not report effects for subgroups under 10 students.

08 Other

FIELD	ENTRY
Data availability	[Aggregate, suppressed class-level file and analysis code, under the terms in the Publication, Authorship and Data Licence Policy]
Conflicts of interest	[]
Funding	[]
Additional comments	[]

09 After registration

DO NOT CHANGE THIS document. If you must change the plan, file a dated amendment that explains why, before looking at outcome data where possible. Keep the registration number on the final report.

This template is educational guidance, not legal advice.